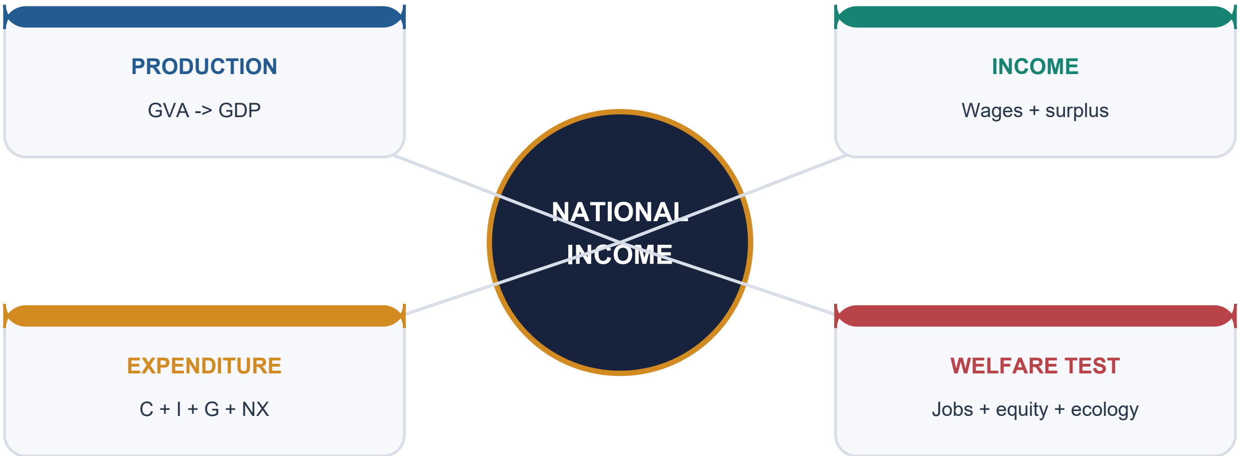
SOLVED PRACTICE WORKBOOK

UPSC complete learning session | Foundation to advanced | Concepts, evidence, practice and answer writing



Deterministic fallback visual: national income viewed through production, income, expenditure and welfare lenses.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

35. State variation and good practice

Visual 33 - Why States differ

Enabling factor	Effect
political commitment	deeper subject and fund transfer
clear activity mapping	less duplication
local cadre/control	accountable staff
strong SFC	predictable fiscal system
participatory planning	citizen-linked priorities
own-revenue reform	greater local discretion

- [ANALYSIS] Kerala's participatory planning and Karnataka's early devolution are standard qualitative illustrations.
- [LIMIT] Avoid unverified percentages, current ranks or claims of uniform success.

36. Reform agenda

Visual 34 - From three Fs to functionality

Problem	Reform
vague functions	binding activity maps for all 29 subjects
weak staff control	Panchayat cadres or accountable placement
tied finance	predictable untied transfers and tax assignment
weak own revenue	updated registers, fair rates, collection support
delayed SFCs	fixed calendar, data secretariat and action reports
proxy representation	legal enforcement, training and peer support
weak Gram Sabha	notice, accessible records, inclusion and follow-up
digital divide	assisted access and offline alternatives

37. Compulsory versus enabling provisions

Visual 35 - Constitutional design

Relatively mandatory	State-discretion/enabling
Gram Sabha recognition	exact Gram Sabha powers
tiers subject to population exception	detailed Panchayat powers
direct territorial elections	devolution of 29 subjects
reservation floor	backward-class reservation
five-year term/elections	tax authorisation and assignments
SEC and SFC	composition details within constitutional bounds

- [ANALYSIS] The Amendment guarantees democratic form more strongly than self-government substance.

38. Panchayati Raj and cooperative federalism

- [ANALYSIS] Local bodies are constitutionally recognised but remain primarily within State legislative and administrative control.
- [ANALYSIS] Union schemes and Finance Commission grants can strengthen capacity yet also increase upward conditionality.
- [LIMIT] Panchayats are not constitutionally co-equal sovereign units with Union and States; "third tier" describes governance structure, not identical federal status.

39. Answer-writing evidence discipline

Visual 36 - Evidence chain

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CLAIM
 -> EXACT ARTICLE / STATUTE
 -> MECHANISM
 -> NAMED PROGRAMME OR STATE EXAMPLE
 -> ANALYSIS
 -> QUALIFICATION
 -> VERDICT
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Example

- Claim: Panchayats remain fiscally dependent.
- Article: 243H is enabling; 243I requires SFC.
- Mechanism: States choose tax authority/assignments; SFC delays weaken sharing.
- Current evidence: XVI FC rural-local-body guidelines supplement resources.
- Qualification: grants are necessary for equity but cannot replace own revenue.
- Verdict: fiscal autonomy requires State tax devolution plus capacity.

PYQ, practice and solved workbook

Verified routed Mains PYQs

PYQ 1 - UPSC GS-II 2018, Q15

Verified neutral demand: Assess the Panchayat system and explain the possible financing sources for Panchayat projects other than government grants. **15 marks | 250 words**

Model answer

Claim: [FACT] The 73rd Amendment secured Panchayat existence, elections and inclusion, but fiscal self-government remains dependent on State action under Article 243H.

Assessment: Part IX provides three tiers, Gram Sabha, five-year terms, reservations, SEC and SFC. Yet Article 243G/H are enabling; incomplete activity mapping, staff dependence and tied transfers produce political decentralisation without full functionality.

Non-grant sources: State-authorised house/property and market taxes; licence and service fees; water/sanitation user charges; tolls; rent from shops, markets and Panchayat buildings; income from ponds, fisheries, community property and haats; assigned State taxes/cesses; and limited borrowing under State law.

Why important: Own revenue strengthens discretion, creditworthiness and downward taxpayer accountability.

Constraints and reform: Update property/asset registers through lawful survey systems, set fair rates, digitise billing, protect poor users, assign buoyant revenues and professionalise collection. SFC recommendations should guide sharing.

Qualification: [LIMIT] Grants remain essential for poor Panchayats and equalisation.

Verdict: The constitutional tools exist; fiscal autonomy requires States to authorise viable taxes and Panchayats to collect them credibly.

PYQ 2 - UPSC GS-II 2019, Q13 - cross-cutting

Verified neutral demand: Comment on whether reservation of seats for women in local bodies has effectively weakened patriarchy. **15 marks | 250 words**

Model answer

Claim: [ANALYSIS] Article 243D has weakened the monopoly of men over local office, but numerical representation has only partially transformed patriarchal power.

Constitutional shock: Not less than one-third of seats and chairperson offices are reserved for women, including SC/ST women; many States provide 50%. This created a large leadership pipeline and normalised women as public decision-makers.

Substantive gains: Women representatives often foreground water, sanitation, health and welfare; experience builds confidence, networks and future candidacy.

Persistent barriers: Sarpanch-pati proxy rule, household control, caste violence, low literacy/digital access, bureaucratic gatekeeping, no-confidence politics and rotation can weaken independent authority.

Reform: punish proxy exercise of office, ensure direct financial/signature control, provide continuous training and legal support, link elected women with SHGs and reserve leadership offices with adequate tenure.

Qualification: [LIMIT] Outcomes vary; neither universal empowerment nor universal proxy is accurate.

Verdict: Reservation is a necessary structural intervention that has begun to erode patriarchy; support institutions determine whether a reserved seat becomes real power.

PYQ 3 - UPSC GS-II 2020, Q13 - cross-cutting

Verified neutral demand: Highlight the challenges in moving local institutions from functions, functionaries and funds to actual functionality. **15 marks | 250 words**

Model answer

Claim: [FACT] The 73rd Amendment constitutionalised Panchayats but left substantive devolution largely to States, creating formally recognised yet unevenly functional institutions.

Functions: Article 243G and the Eleventh Schedule are enabling; incomplete activity mapping and parallel agencies blur responsibility.

Functionaries: teachers, engineers, health and agriculture staff often remain under line departments, so elected bodies cannot direct delivery or enforce accountability.

Funds: Article 243H taxation is under-used, SFCs are delayed or weak, own revenue is low and grants are frequently tied.

Cross-cutting constraints: weak Gram Sabhas, capacity gaps, proxy leadership, irregular data, poor district-plan convergence and digital exclusion.

Path to functionality: binding activity maps, staff placement/control, predictable untied finance, SFC calendars, own-revenue reform, professional support, social audit and outcome-based GPDPs.

Qualification: [LIMIT] State variation is large; strong examples show the design can work.

Verdict: The three Fs must be devolved together and tested by citizen-visible services, not by transfer notifications.

Routed Prelims demand - provenance without invented answer letter

Prelims route 1 - 2025 GS-I Q91

Verified neutral demand: Constitutional position of Panchayats at the intermediate level.

Doctrinal solution

- [FACT] The intermediate tier is the Panchayat Samiti/block/taluka level.
- [FACT] A State with population not exceeding 20 lakh may omit it.
- [FACT] Territorial seats are directly elected, while the chairperson is indirectly elected.
- [FACT] State law may provide representation for MPs/MLAs and village chairpersons.

Elimination rule: Reject statements making the intermediate tier compulsory in every State or making every chairperson directly elected.

Original MCQ loop - strict A -> B -> C -> D rotation

OM1. Constitutional amendment

Panchayati Raj received constitutional status through:

A. 73rd Amendment. B. 74th Amendment. C. 42nd Amendment. D. 44th Amendment.

Answer: A.

Explanation: [FACT] Passed in 1992 and effective 24 April 1993.

OM2. Part

The Panchayat provisions are in:

A. Part IXA. B. Part IX. C. Part X. D. Part XXI.

Answer: B.

Explanation: [FACT] Articles 243-243O.

OM3. Schedule

The Eleventh Schedule contains:

A. 18 subjects. B. 12 subjects. C. 29 subjects. D. 30 subjects.

Answer: C.

Explanation: [FACT] Twelfth Schedule has 18 municipal matters.

OM4. DPSP root

Village Panchayats are directed by:

A. Article 39A. B. Article 48A. C. Article 50. D. Article 40.

Answer: D.

Explanation: [FACT] It is a Directive Principle.

OM5. Gram Sabha

Gram Sabha consists of:

A. registered voters in the village area. B. elected Panchayat members only. C. village officials only. D. all residents regardless of electoral registration.

Answer: A.

Explanation: [FACT] Article 243A.

OM6. Intermediate exemption

A State may omit the intermediate tier if population is:

A. below 10 lakh. B. not exceeding 20 lakh. C. below 50 lakh. D. determined by Parliament each year.

Answer: B.

Explanation: [FACT] Article 243B.

OM7. Territorial seats

Territorial seats at the three tiers are:

A. nominated. B. indirectly elected. C. directly elected. D. appointed by Governor.

Answer: C.

Explanation: [FACT] Chairperson rules differ.

OM8. District chairperson

The district Panchayat chairperson is generally:

A. directly elected by all district voters. B. appointed by Governor. C. selected by MPs. D. elected by and from elected members.

Answer: D.

Explanation: [FACT] Article 243C.

OM9. Women's seats

The constitutional floor is:

A. not less than one-third. B. exactly one-half. C. one-fourth. D. two-thirds.

Answer: A.

Explanation: [FACT] States may raise it.

OM10. Backward classes

Reservation for backward classes in Panchayats:

A. is prohibited. B. may be provided by State legislature. C. must be fixed by Parliament at 27%. D. is decided by SFC.

Answer: B.

Explanation: [FACT] Article 243D permits State provision.

OM11. Normal term

A Panchayat's normal duration is:

A. four years. B. six years. C. five years. D. permanent.

Answer: C.

Explanation: [FACT] Article 243E.

OM12. Dissolution election

Fresh election is ordinarily required within:

A. one year. B. three months. C. two years. D. six months.

Answer: D.

Explanation: [FACT] Subject to the short-remainder qualification.

OM13. Candidate age

Minimum age is:

A. 21. B. 25. C. 30. D. 18.

Answer: A.

Explanation: [FACT] Article 243F prevents disqualification merely for being below 25 after age 21.

OM14. Article 243G

This Article concerns:

A. elections. B. powers, authority and responsibilities. C. audit only. D. exclusions.

Answer: B.

Explanation: [FACT] It links to Eleventh Schedule plans and schemes.

OM15. Devolution language

Article 243G means:

A. all 29 subjects automatically transfer. B. Union transfers subjects directly. C. State legislature may endow Panchayats by law. D. Gram Sabha controls every department.

Answer: C.

Explanation: [FACT] It is enabling.

OM16. Finance

Article 243H:

A. creates RBI grants. B. gives automatic GST share. C. establishes SEC. D. enables State-authorised local taxes, assignments, grants and funds.

Answer: D.

Explanation: [FACT] State law controls the fiscal authority.

OM17. Own-source revenue

Which is own/non-grant revenue?

A. authorised property tax. B. Union Finance Commission grant. C. State grant-in-aid. D. centrally sponsored scheme transfer.

Answer: A.

Explanation: [FACT] Own taxes/fees differ from transfers.

OM18. SFC

The State Finance Commission is constituted:

A. annually. B. every five years. C. every ten years. D. only on Assembly request.

Answer: B.

Explanation: [FACT] Article 243I.

OM19. Elections

Panchayat elections are conducted by:

A. ECI. B. District Collector alone. C. State Election Commission. D. SFC.

Answer: C.

Explanation: [FACT] Article 243K.

OM20. Audit

Accounts and audit are addressed by:

A. 243G. B. 243H. C. 243I. D. 243J.

Answer: D.

Explanation: [FACT] State law provides the framework.

OM21. Election challenge

A Panchayat election is ordinarily challenged by:

A. election petition under State law. B. pre-election civil suit in every case. C. presidential reference. D. SFC review.

Answer: A.

Explanation: [FACT] Article 243O.

OM22. PESA

PESA extends Panchayat principles to:

A. Sixth Schedule areas. B. Fifth Schedule areas. C. every urban ward. D. cantonments.

Answer: B.

Explanation: [FACT] Enacted in 1996.

OM23. PESA institution

The central participatory body is:

A. District Collector. B. Rajya Sabha. C. Gram Sabha. D. NEC.

Answer: C.

Explanation: [FACT] PESA recognises customary/community governance.

OM24. Social audit

Social audit is best described as:

A. CAG certification only. B. departmental inspection. C. court trial. D. community verification of records and outcomes.

Answer: D.

Explanation: [ANALYSIS] It requires disclosure and public hearing.

OM25. Three Fs

They are:

A. functions, functionaries and funds. B. federalism, finance and fairness. C. food, fuel and fertiliser. D. files, forms and fees.

Answer: A.

Explanation: [ANALYSIS] Together they create functionality.

OM26. Functionaries gap

A common problem is:

A. every Panchayat has independent cadre. B. staff remain accountable to State line departments. C. no State role exists. D. Gram Sabha appoints all officers.

Answer: B.

Explanation: [ANALYSIS] Authority and accountability become misaligned.

OM27. Devolution Index

The official index evaluates:

A. election turnout only. B. village population only. C. multiple dimensions including functions, finances and functionaries. D. Lok Sabha seats.

Answer: C.

Explanation: [CURRENT] Rankings are report- and year-specific.

OM28. Central grants

XVI Finance Commission rural-local-body guidelines cover:

A. 2020-25. B. 2025-26 only. C. 2031-36. D. 2026-27 to 2030-31.

Answer: D.

Explanation: [CURRENT] Official operational guidelines are published.

OM29. eGramSwaraj

It primarily supports:

A. Panchayat planning and financial/progress workflows. B. Supreme Court appointments. C. military command. D. parliamentary voting.

Answer: A.

Explanation: [CURRENT] It is a digital local-governance platform.

OM30. AuditOnline

It supports:

A. election delimitation. B. digital audit workflows. C. property title adjudication. D. criminal trials.

Answer: B.

Explanation: [CURRENT] Audit complements accounting and public scrutiny.

OM31. SVAMITVA

The scheme uses:

A. satellite voting. B. judicial surveys. C. drone-based rural inhabited-area mapping and property cards. D. forest-right cancellation.

Answer: C.

Explanation: [FACT] Legal effect still depends on State property law.

OM32. GPDP

A strong GPDP:

A. is only a portal form. B. excludes Gram Sabha. C. lists Union schemes only. D. links local needs, resources, activities and outcomes.

Answer: D.

Explanation: [ANALYSIS] Participatory planning requires a resource envelope.

OM33. SFC versus UFC

Which is correct?

A. SFC reviews local finances within the State. B. SFC is constituted by President. C. UFC conducts Panchayat elections. D. Both are identical.

Answer: A.

Explanation: [FACT] Governor constitutes SFC.

OM34. Part IX exclusion

Ordinary Part IX does not directly apply to:

A. every State. B. Nagaland, Meghalaya and Mizoram among specified exclusions. C. all plains. D. all Union Territories.

Answer: B.

Explanation: [FACT] Article 243M contains exclusions.

OM35. Third tier

Panchayats are:

A. sovereign units equal to States. B. Union departments. C. constitutionally recognised local governments whose substantive powers depend heavily on State law. D. courts.

Answer: C.

Explanation: [FACT/ANALYSIS] Constitutional status is not co-equal sovereignty.

OM36. Functionality

The strongest test is:

A. number of portal entries. B. number of committees alone. C. election frequency only. D. citizen-visible services backed by functions, staff and funds.

Answer: D.

Explanation: [ANALYSIS] Outputs and accountability complete devolution.

Remedial MCQs - strict A -> B -> C -> D rotation

R1. Commencement trap

The 73rd Amendment came into force:

A. 24 April 1993. B. 26 January 1992. C. 2 October 1959. D. 1 June 1996.

Answer: A.

Remedy: Passed 1992, operational 1993.

R2. Schedule trap

Panchayat subjects:

A. Twelfth Schedule, 18. B. Eleventh Schedule, 29. C. Seventh Schedule, 30. D. Fifth Schedule, 29.

Answer: B.

Remedy: Eleventh rural; Twelfth urban.

R3. Tier trap

The skippable tier is:

A. village. B. district. C. intermediate, for States not exceeding 20 lakh population. D. all tiers.

Answer: C.

Remedy: Village and district remain.

R4. Chairperson trap

Intermediate/district chairpersons are:

A. always nominated. B. directly elected by all voters. C. appointed by SEC. D. indirectly elected by and from elected members.

Answer: D.

Remedy: Territorial seats are directly elected.

R5. Reservation trap

Women's constitutional reservation is:

A. not less than one-third. B. exactly one-third ceiling. C. one-fourth. D. only at village level.

Answer: A.

Remedy: States may provide 50%.

R6. Tax trap

Panchayat taxation depends on:

A. automatic constitutional tax list. B. State-law authorisation under Article 243H. C. SFC collection. D. ECI approval.

Answer: B.

Remedy: Article 243H is enabling.

R7. Election-body trap

Panchayat elections:

A. ECI. B. CAG. C. SEC. D. UFC.

Answer: C.

Remedy: Article 243K.

R8. PESA trap

PESA covers:

A. Sixth Schedule. B. municipalities. C. cantonments. D. Fifth Schedule areas.

Answer: D.

Remedy: PESA is tribal rural self-government in Scheduled Areas.

R9. Own-revenue trap

Which is non-grant?

A. user charge authorised by State law. B. Central Finance Commission grant. C. State grant. D. scheme transfer.

Answer: A.

Remedy: Separate own income from transfers.

R10. SFC trap

SFC:

A. conducts elections. B. reviews local-body finances every five years. C. appoints Panchayat staff. D. audits Parliament.

Answer: B.

Remedy: Article 243I.

R11. Digital trap

SVAMITVA:

A. automatically grants conclusive title everywhere. B. replaces State property law. C. supports mapping/property records subject to State legal processes. D. is an election platform.

Answer: C.

Remedy: Survey technology is not universal title adjudication.

R12. Functionality trap

Portal compliance:

A. proves all 29 subjects devolved. B. proves Gram Sabha consent. C. eliminates staff shortages. D. is useful evidence but not proof of substantive self-government.

Answer: D.

Remedy: Verify powers, staff, funds and outcomes.

Original solved Mains practice

M1. "The 73rd Amendment constitutionalised Panchayats but did not constitutionalise devolution." Examine. (10 marks, 150 words)

Model answer

Claim: [FACT] Part IX guarantees institutional form more strongly than substantive power.

Named evidence: Articles 243B-243F mandate tiers, elections, reservations and tenure; Articles 243I and 243K require SFC and SEC. But Article 243G says States may endow powers over the 29 subjects, while Article 243H makes local taxation depend on State law.

Analysis: States can comply through elections while retaining line departments, staff and buoyant revenues. Panchayats then have responsibility without authority.

Qualification: [LIMIT] Strong State examples show the framework permits deep devolution.

Verdict: The Amendment settled political decentralisation; binding activity mapping, staff control and predictable finance are needed to constitutionalise its self-government promise in practice.

M2. Evaluate Gram Sabha as an institution of participatory democracy. (15 marks, 250 words)

Model answer

Claim: [FACT] Article 243A makes the Gram Sabha the direct-democracy foundation of rural local government, while State law and PESA determine its operative power.

Potential: It identifies needs, approves plans/beneficiaries where law provides, monitors works, conducts social audits and gives marginal groups a public forum. Under PESA it protects custom and community resources.

Constraints: poor notice, elite capture, gender/caste exclusion, unreadable records, low quorum, bureaucratic agenda control and weak follow-up convert meetings into ritual.

Reform: scheduled calendars, advance public records, facilitated inclusion, ward-level preparation, social-audit units, speaking orders on resolutions and digital-plus-physical access.

Qualification: [LIMIT] Direct participation cannot replace the elected Panchayat or professional administration.

Verdict: Gram Sabha is transformative when information, voice and consequence meet; without enforceable follow-up it remains consultation without power.

M3. Analyse the fiscal architecture of Panchayati Raj. (15 marks, 250 words)

Model answer

Claim: [FACT] Panchayat finance combines own revenue, assigned State revenue, State grants, SFC sharing and Union Finance Commission supplementation.

Constitutional design: Article 243H enables taxes, duties, tolls, fees, assignments, grants and Panchayat Funds. Article 243I requires SFC review every five years. Article 280 links Union Finance Commission measures to augment State funds for Panchayats.

Weakness: State authorisation is narrow, registers and collection weak, SFCs delayed, grants tied and richer/poorer Panchayat tax bases unequal.

Reform: predictable tax assignment, modern asset/property registers, fair user charges, professional billing, untied equalisation grants, SFC secretariats and public fiscal dashboards.

Current control: [CURRENT] XVI FC rural-local-body operational guidelines cover 2026-31.

Verdict: Grants secure equity; own revenue secures discretion and accountability. A healthy system needs both.

M4. Discuss PESA as a model of tribal self-government. (15 marks, 250 words)

Model answer

Claim: [FACT] PESA, 1996 adapts Part IX to Fifth Schedule areas by placing custom, community resources and the Gram Sabha at the centre.

Design: State laws must respect customary practices. Gram Sabhas approve plans and beneficiaries and hold roles concerning minor forest produce, land alienation, village markets, money-lending, land acquisition and minor minerals.

Significance: It shifts tribal administration from guardianship toward self-rule and complements Forest Rights Act community rights.

Gaps: delayed/inadequate State rules, bureaucratic control, mining/land pressures, weak record access, confusion over consultation versus recommendation and digital exclusion.

Reform: harmonise State laws, map Gram Sabha powers, require documented prior processes, strengthen community-resource records and create independent grievance review.

Qualification: [LIMIT] PESA applies to Fifth, not Sixth, Schedule areas.

Verdict: PESA is constitutionally inspired democratic autonomy whose failure lies mainly in under-implementation, not lack of legal ambition.

M5. Can digital platforms solve the accountability deficit in Panchayats? Critically examine. (15 marks, 250 words)

Model answer

Claim: [CURRENT] eGramSwaraj, AuditOnline and SVAMITVA can improve records, traceability and planning, but cannot substitute for devolution or citizen power.

Benefits: integrated plans/accounts, public progress, audit trails, better property mapping, reduced record fragmentation and data for case-specific intervention.

Limits: poor connectivity, shared credentials, low digital literacy, inaccurate data, portal-driven planning, privacy/cyber risks and exclusion of citizens without assisted access.

Institutional point: A perfectly entered plan is ineffective if staff answer to line departments, funds are tied and Gram Sabha resolutions lack consequence.

Safeguards: local-language design, e-Sewa assistance, offline options, independent audit, data-quality checks, public hearings and human decision control.

Verdict: Digital systems are accountability infrastructure; democracy still requires powers, transparent records and organised citizen scrutiny.

M6. "Own-source revenue is both a fiscal and democratic reform." Comment. (15 marks, 250 words)

Model answer

Claim: [ANALYSIS] Local taxation finances discretion and creates a direct accountability relationship between payer and elected Panchayat.

Fiscal value: taxes, fees, user charges, tolls and property income diversify resources and reduce dependence on delayed/tied grants. Better records under lawful survey systems can expand the base.

Democratic value: Citizens paying visible local levies demand service standards, budget transparency and justification of rates. Panchayats gain bargaining capacity and planning flexibility.

Risks: regressive fees, political reluctance, weak assessment, coercive collection and unequal local bases.

Design: progressive exemptions, affordable lifeline services, transparent rate-setting, grievance mechanisms, State equalisation grants and professional collection.

Qualification: [LIMIT] Own revenue cannot finance equal services in every poor rural jurisdiction.

Verdict: Own-source reform strengthens self-government when paired with equity transfers and accountable service delivery.

M7. Assess Panchayati Raj as a vehicle of social transformation. (20 marks, 250 words)

Model answer

Claim: [FACT] Panchayati Raj transforms democracy by relocating representation, planning and accountability to everyday rural life.

Inclusion: Article 243D reserves SC/ST and women's seats; many States use a 50% women's quota. New leadership can alter agendas and aspirations.

Participation: Gram Sabhas, social audits and GPDPs let citizens shape plans and inspect expenditure. PESA adds tribal custom/resource rights.

Delivery: the Eleventh Schedule connects local institutions with livelihoods, water, sanitation, health, education and welfare.

Limits: elite capture, proxy women leaders, caste exclusion, weak three-F devolution, parallel agencies, delayed SFCs and digital barriers.

Reform: protected participation, leadership support, own revenue, staff control, transparent activity maps, social audit and enforceable Gram Sabha follow-up.

Verdict: Panchayats have democratised access to office more than control over the State. Their transformative promise depends on converting representation into authority and services.

M8. Design a reform programme to move Panchayats from the three Fs to functionality. (20 marks, 250 words)

Model answer

Claim: [ANALYSIS] Functionality requires a sequenced institutional compact, not isolated grants or training.

Functions: enact binding activity maps for all devolved Eleventh Schedule matters, eliminate duplicate mandates and integrate GPDP with district planning.

Functionaries: create local cadres or place sector staff under Panchayat performance/attendance control, supported by technical pools.

Funds: authorise viable taxes, assign predictable State revenues, implement SFC recommendations, increase untied equalisation and publish fund-flow calendars.

Democracy/accountability: strengthen Gram Sabha notice and records, independent social audits, anti-proxy enforcement, SEC autonomy and public outcome dashboards.

Capacity/technology: continuous role-based training, local-language eGramSwaraj assistance, data-quality audits and privacy safeguards.

Measurement: use the Devolution Index dimensions and citizen service outcomes rather than subject-transfer claims alone.

Verdict: Functionality begins when the elected Panchayat can decide, direct staff, spend predictable money and answer publicly for outcomes.